

Question				Marking details	Marks Available				
					AO1	AO2	AO3	Total	Maths * Prac **
7				<u>Indicative content</u> Eutrophication - The nitrogen in the food fed to the fish may be lost as uneaten food, in faeces and as ammonia. - The extra N and P in the water can be used by algae to grow. This algal bloom at the water surface can block light to the aquatic plants in the deeper water. - With no light, these plants cannot photosynthesise and so die. - Decomposers (bacteria and fungi) will then decompose the dead organic matter. They use (aerobic) respiration and so use up oxygen from the water. - The water becomes deoxygenated and fish and other oxygen requiring species die. - Anaerobic bacteria may start to reduce nitrates (denitrification) Other impacts of fish farming - The farmed fish tend to be packed tightly into a small area. - This can lead to diseases passing through the population quickly and these can spread to the local wild fish population. - To keep the stock healthy antibiotics are used. This can lead to antibiotic resistant bacteria developing. - Pesticides used to kill the parasites may also be toxic to some of the local marine invertebrates. - Farmed fish may have a selective advantage over wild species Methods of preventing overfishing - Net mesh sizes may be restricted. Larger mesh sizes allow immature fish to escape and they can go on to interbreed. - Closed seasons for fishing are also enforced. These will be at times of the year when fish are breeding so again the stocks are replenished. - Quotas - agreements which limit the catches brought ashore. - Around the coast there are exclusion zones where fishing is not allowed. These areas allow fish to reproduce without being caught. - Landing size regulations have been introduced which only allowing fish of a certain size to be caught. This allows some fish to return for breeding. Fishing of non-traditional varieties e.g. coalfish, has allowed stocks of other fish to recover.	5	4		9	